

STANDARD OPERATING PROCEDURE

Employee Onboarding Process

Document Reference	SOP-HR-001
Version	2.3
Effective Date	01 March 2025
Review Date	01 March 2026
Owner	Human Resources Department
Approved By	Chief People Officer
Classification	Internal Use Only
Applicable To	All new permanent, contract, and seconded employees

1. Purpose

This Standard Operating Procedure defines the end-to-end process for onboarding new employees into the organisation. It ensures that all new hires receive a consistent, compliant, and positive onboarding experience, and that all administrative, IT, and compliance requirements are fulfilled prior to and on the employee's first day of employment.

2. Scope

This procedure applies to:

- All permanent full-time and part-time employees
- Fixed-term contract employees
- Seconded employees from partner organisations
- Graduate and intern intake programmes

This procedure does NOT cover: freelance contractors, agency workers, or consultants engaged via third-party agreements. Refer to SOP-PROC-012 (Contractor Engagement) for those engagements.

3. Roles and Responsibilities

Role	Responsibilities
HR Business Partner	Initiates onboarding workflow upon signed offer acceptance; coordinates all pre-boarding communications; manages compliance documentation; closes the onboarding case at 90-day mark.
Hiring Manager	Prepares team and workspace; conducts Day 1 welcome briefing; assigns buddy; conducts 30/60/90-day check-ins; approves probation completion.
IT Department	Provisions hardware, software licences, email account, and system access credentials; provides IT induction within 48 hours of start date.

Payroll	Verifies banking and tax documentation; sets up payroll record; confirms first pay date to employee in writing.
Facilities / Security	Issues building access card and parking permit (if applicable); provides site orientation.
New Employee	Completes pre-boarding documentation; attends all mandatory induction sessions; completes compliance training within specified deadlines.

4. Pre-requisites and Triggers

This process is triggered when all of the following conditions are met:

- Signed employment contract received by HR
- Background check clearance confirmed (where applicable)
- Start date confirmed by Hiring Manager
- Headcount approval confirmed in HR system

5. Onboarding Process Steps

5.1 Pre-Boarding Phase (T-14 to T-1 days before start date)

#	Step / Activity	Responsible Party	Output / System
1	Send welcome email with onboarding pack	HR Business Partner	Welcome email sent; Onboarding portal link included
2	Employee completes pre-boarding forms online	New Employee	Tax declaration, bank details, emergency contacts submitted via HR portal
3	Verify and process pre-boarding documents	HR Business Partner	Documents validated; payroll record initiated in HRIS
4	Raise IT provisioning request	HR Business Partner	IT ticket created in ServiceNow; hardware and software specified
5	IT provisions hardware and accounts	IT Department	Laptop, email account, M365 licence, VPN access ready by T-1
6	Prepare physical workspace	Facilities	Desk assigned, access card issued, parking permit arranged if applicable
7	Hiring Manager briefs team and assigns buddy	Hiring Manager	Team notified; buddy confirmed and briefed on role

5.2 Day 1 Activities

Decision gate: If the employee fails to arrive without prior notification, HR must be contacted immediately to place the onboarding process on hold and initiate the no-show protocol (see Section 7.1).

#	Step / Activity	Responsible Party	Output / System
8	Facilities welcome and site orientation	Facilities / Security	Access card activated; site tour completed
9	HR induction meeting	HR Business Partner	Employment terms, policies, and benefits confirmed; signed acknowledgement received
10	IT induction and equipment handover	IT Department	Equipment received and signed for; credentials issued; IT acceptable use policy signed
11	Hiring Manager welcome meeting	Hiring Manager	Team introductions; 30/60/90-day goals discussed; buddy introduced
12	Enrol in mandatory compliance training	HR Business Partner	Employee enrolled in Code of Conduct, Data Privacy, and Health & Safety modules via LMS

5.3 First 30 Days

#	Step / Activity	Responsible Party	Output / System
13	Complete mandatory compliance training	New Employee	All assigned LMS modules completed and passed within 14 business days
14	30-day check-in meeting	Hiring Manager	Documented check-in; any concerns escalated to HR
15	Payroll confirmation	Payroll	Employee confirms receipt of first pay; payslip query process explained

5.4 60 and 90-Day Milestones

#	Step / Activity	Responsible Party	Output / System
16	60-day probation review	Hiring Manager	Written review completed; performance against goals documented in HRIS
17	90-day final probation review	Hiring Manager + HR	Pass: probation confirmed in writing. Fail: extended probation or exit process initiated per SOP-HR-007

18	Close onboarding case	HR Business Partner	Onboarding record closed in HRIS; employee transitioned to standard HR lifecycle
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6. Decision Points and Exception Handling

6.1 Employee No-Show on Day 1

If the new employee does not appear on their scheduled start date without prior notification:

1. HR Business Partner contacts the employee via phone within 1 hour of scheduled start time.
2. If no response within 4 hours, Hiring Manager is notified.
3. If no response by end of business day, HR initiates the no-show protocol and places onboarding on hold.
4. Offer may be withdrawn after 2 business days of no contact, subject to legal review.

6.2 Failed Background Check (Post-Offer)

If a background check returns an adverse result after the offer has been accepted but before the start date:

5. HR Business Partner immediately notifies the Hiring Manager and Legal.
6. Legal reviews the specific adverse findings and provides a written recommendation within 3 business days.
7. If the offer is to be withdrawn, HR sends a formal withdrawal letter per the template in Appendix B.
8. All pre-provisioned IT access and physical credentials are revoked within 24 hours of withdrawal decision.

6.3 Probation Failure

If the 90-day review results in a recommendation to not confirm employment:

- HR must be involved before any communication is made to the employee.
- A separate process (SOP-HR-007: Performance Management and Separation) is initiated.
- Onboarding case remains open until the separation process is complete.

7. Systems and Tools

System / Tool	Purpose	Access Required
Workday HRIS	Employee record creation, onboarding workflow, training enrolment	HR Business Partner, Hiring Manager

ServiceNow	IT provisioning requests, facilities tickets	HR Business Partner, IT, Facilities
Microsoft 365	Email, Teams, SharePoint onboarding portal	All parties
LMS (Cornerstone)	Mandatory compliance training assignments	HR Business Partner, New Employee
DocuSign	Digital signature for employment documentation	HR Business Partner, New Employee

8. Key Performance Indicators

- Time-to-productivity: New employee reaches full productivity within 90 days (measured via manager assessment)
- Onboarding completion rate: 100% of mandatory training completed within 14 business days of start date
- 30-day satisfaction score: New employee NPS score of 8+ on Day 30 pulse survey
- IT provisioning SLA: All equipment and access ready by T-1 (Day before start); measured via ServiceNow ticket closure
- Pre-boarding completion: All pre-boarding forms submitted at least 5 business days before start date

9. Related Documents

- SOP-HR-007: Performance Management and Separation
- SOP-PROC-012: Contractor Engagement
- POL-HR-001: Employment Policy
- POL-IT-004: Acceptable Use Policy
- Appendix A: New Employee Onboarding Checklist
- Appendix B: Offer Withdrawal Letter Template

10. Document Control and Revision History

Version	Date	Author	Summary of Changes
1.0	15 Jan 2022	J. Santos, HR Director	Initial release
2.0	10 Jun 2023	M. Lim, HR BP	Added pre-boarding digital forms; integrated ServiceNow ticketing; updated KPIs
2.1	03 Nov 2023	M. Lim, HR BP	Clarified no-show protocol; added background check exception handling
2.2	15 Jul 2024	A. Tan, HR BP	Aligned to Workday HRIS migration; updated system references

2.3	01 Mar 2025	A. Tan, HR BP	Added Appendix B (offer withdrawal template); updated review SLAs
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